IDEA9106 Design Thinking
Week 9 Tutorial: Usability testing hypothesis and plan outline
(also on Week 9 Figma board)

Testing hypothesis
If we make a **[Drifted Message, an interactive piece of art(bottle) on the wall with an anonymous message system]**
We expect to help **[international students]** and local students to connect and **[reduce the disconnectivity]** on the campus
By **[providing a chance for them to meet up with the people who shared the same interests and ice breaking each other from sharing their thoughts].**

Testing plan outline

- Name of the prototype being testing

=Message Drift

- Description of the prototype being testing eg., mobile, freestanding kiosk, VR game etc

= It is a mixed testing between offline and online prototypes. A lo-fi physical bottle with a number labeled on it taped on the cardboard kiosk wall with a mobile prototype screen lying beside the bottle, and a cut-out circle token. A cutout paper will be taped on the wall between 2 bottles in the middle to show a line/dot to connect the two bottles together when the system pairs them together. Behind the bottle is a tiny hole cutout so that a flashlight can be shone to imitate that the bottle itself is interactive and can light up or change color based on the prototype system that detects the mood of the user's message. The user will first interact with the mobile prototype, then the physical object(bottle) will simulate the process of the interaction by being lit up, and then the user will use the cutout token to tap on the prototype screen to continue with the process. A line/dot will be physically shown to simulate how the linking of bottles works.

- Testing goal/s:

= Able to fulfil the objective of the project, it should be clear and successfully guide the tester to help them complete the interaction, and be able to receive benefits afterward.

1. To test whether users understand how to leave a short anonymous message.
2. To test whether users understand that their message will become part of the wall, a glowing bottle on the wall creates a piece of art.
3. To test whether the user understands how to see or respond to another student's bottle.

4. To test whether users understand the meaning of each color represented on the bottle, the use of the token, and the visual graphics.
5. To test whether the interaction feels low-pressure, comfortable, and emotionally supportive.

- Logistics eg. time, dates, location and format of study etc
  Date: Week 10 tutorial, 5/5/2026
  Time: 13:00-15:00
  Location: H70.03.3190. Belinda Hutchinson Building Studio
  Format: In-person usability testing, one participant at a time
  Session length: Around 8–10 minutes per participant

- Participant profile/s
  University students, especially students who use campus spaces.

- Testing method/s

The main testing method will be Think Aloud protocol. Participants will be asked to say what they are thinking while completing each task.

- Testing tasks

1. Able to leave an anonymous message
2. Drift your message into the sea of thoughts
3. Use of the token
4. Connect with another bottle
5. Notify the person who has the token
6. Provide a time slot for connecting with each other

Recommended

- Script for the testing protocol (minimum components)
  Introduction, including seeking consent:

Hi, thank you for participating in our usability test. We are testing a lo-fi prototype called Message Drift. It is an interactive public art installation that allows students to leave, discover, respond, and connect with other students through short anonymous messages.

This is not a test of you. We are testing the design. If something is confusing, it is helpful for us to know. Please think aloud while completing the tasks, which means saying what you are thinking, what you expect to happen, and anything you find confusing.

This session will be video recorded for assessment and analysis purposes. Your responses will only be used for this project. You can stop at any time. Do you consent to participate and be recorded? Please write your name and sign the consent paper for us.

Explanation for Task 1: (You are walking past the Message Drift wall and want to leave a short anonymous feeling or thought. Please use the prototype to leave one message)

Explanation for Task 2:(Throw your bottle from the screen to the wall)

Explanation for Task 3:(Takes the bottle token and taps on the screen, keep your thought with you (magsafe))

Explanation for Task 4:(The system has now found another anonymous bottle that shares similar thoughts/mood/traits with you. Do you want to know them/meet them? Please choose drift in closer so that the system will bring both of you closer)

Explanation for Task 5:(Now that you are interested in meeting the person, you can notify them by sending a quiet hello.)

Explanation for Task 6:(Now you can choose a time slot or leave a message for them. The system will automatically send the signal of your message and let the person with the token know by alerting them with light/vibration on their token to remind them that someone has responded to their message and interest to them and must return to the location)

Post-test instructions/questions:

Questions:

1. Do you feel that you can connect with other students better after this interaction?
2. Do you think the interaction process is clear enough?
3. What part of the interaction was easiest to understand? What part do you think needs refinement?
4. Does an anonymous message make you feel low-pressure and comfortable to share your thoughts?
5. Would choosing a time slot to connect with another student feel helpful or too much pressure?

Thank you for your participation. Please let us know your thoughts by giving your evaluation of the paper.

- Data collection method/s: Record video and transcription.